

HEALING FOR THE HOMES SERIES

GOD, I SINNED. WILL YOU FORGIVE ME?

*If we confess our sins, He is faithful
and just to forgive us.*

— 1 JOHN 1:9



Overcomers
Global Network
EDUCATE , EQUIP , EVOLVE

BY JOSHUA MATTHEWS

DEDICATION

This booklet is dedicated to every believer who has fallen and feels the weight of guilt pressing on their chest. You sinned. You know it. And now you wonder if God will still receive you. The answer is yes — but not without repentance, not without truth, and not without a sincere turning of the heart. These pages will show you the mercy of God and the responsibility He places upon those who receive it.

A MESSAGE FROM THE FOUNDER

Dear Reader,

Many believers carry the burden of sin in silence. They know what they did. They feel the distance it has created between them and God. And they are afraid — afraid that they have gone too far, that God is finished with them, or that forgiveness is no longer available.

The Word of God is clear: there is forgiveness in Jesus Christ for those who repent. The blood of Jesus still cleanses from all sin. The throne of grace is still accessible. But forgiveness is not a casual matter. God does not take sin lightly, and neither should we. His mercy is free, but it is not cheap — it cost the life of His Son.

In this booklet, I will show you what Scripture teaches about God's forgiveness, what true repentance looks like, and how a forgiven person is called to walk in newness of life. Do not stay in guilt. Do not stay in sin. Come back to the Father. He is waiting.

Joshua Matthews\nFounder, Overcomers Global Network

With all my love in Christ,

Joshua Matthews

Founder, Overcomers Global Network

The Cry of the Soul

The weight is there the moment you open your eyes in the morning. Before the world begins, before the phone rings, before the day starts — you feel it. A heaviness in your spirit that whispers the same thing over and over: "You sinned. God knows. And things are not right between you and Him."

Some believers carry this weight for days. Others carry it for months or years — attending church, singing songs, even praying, but knowing deep inside that there is a wall between them and God that was built by their own disobedience.

Maybe it was a deliberate choice — something you knew was wrong before you did it. Maybe it was a moment of weakness that led to a fall you never thought would happen. Maybe it is a pattern you have returned to again and again despite promises to God and yourself that it would be the last time.

Whatever the sin, the result is always the same: distance. Guilt. Shame. A feeling that you have no right to approach God after what you have done.

And alongside the guilt, there is a question that torments: "Will He forgive me? After what I did? After how many times I have done it? Is there a limit to His mercy — and have I reached it?"

Hear this: God's mercy has not run out. But His mercy is not meant to be presumed upon. Let me show you both His compassion and His expectation — because both are necessary for true restoration.

What the Bible Says

The Word of God speaks directly to the believer who has sinned and desires forgiveness:

""If we confess our sins, He is faithful and just to forgive us our sins and to cleanse us from all unrighteousness.""

— 1 John 1:9 (NKJV)

This is a promise with a condition. The condition is confession — honest, specific, humble acknowledgment before God of what you have done. Not excuses. Not minimizing. Not blaming circumstances or other people. Confession says, "God, I did this. It was wrong. I own it. And I need Your mercy."

When you confess, God responds with two things: faithfulness and justice. He is faithful — meaning He keeps His word. He promised to forgive the repentant, and He will not break that promise. He is just — meaning the payment for your sin was already made through the blood of Jesus on the cross. He can forgive you justly because the price was already paid.

""But if we walk in the light as He is in the light, we have fellowship with one another, and the blood of Jesus Christ His Son cleanses us from all sin.""

— 1 John 1:7 (NKJV)

The blood of Jesus cleanses from *all* sin. Not some sin. Not small sin. All sin. There is no category of transgression that exceeds the reach of Christ's sacrifice. Murder, adultery, theft, deception, lust, hatred — all of it is covered by the blood for those who repent.

David understood this when he wrote Psalm 51 after his great fall with Bathsheba:

""Have mercy upon me, O God, according to Your lovingkindness; according to the multitude of Your tender mercies, blot out my transgressions. Wash me thoroughly from my iniquity, and cleanse me from my sin. For I acknowledge my transgressions, and my sin is always before me.""

— Psalm 51:1–3 (NKJV)

David did not minimize what he did. He did not say, "It was a mistake." He called it transgression. He called it iniquity. He called it sin. And he appealed to God's mercy — not to his own goodness — as the basis for forgiveness.

This is critical: forgiveness is not based on how good you are after the sin. It is based on how merciful God is toward the repentant heart. Your works cannot earn it. Only the blood of Jesus can secure it.

But there is another verse that many overlook:

""He who covers his sins will not prosper, but whoever confesses and forsakes them will have mercy.""

— **Proverbs 28:13 (NKJV)**

Confess *and* forsake. Forgiveness requires both — acknowledging the sin and turning away from it. A person who confesses but returns to the same sin without genuine effort to change is not repenting. They are informing God of their plans to continue. That is not repentance. That is presumption.

The Root of the Struggle

The Difference Between Godly Sorrow and Worldly Sorrow.

Paul explained this distinction clearly:

""For godly sorrow produces repentance leading to salvation, not to be regretted; but the sorrow of the world produces death.""

— **2 Corinthians 7:10 (NKJV)**

Godly sorrow is grief over offending God. It says, "I have sinned against a holy God who loves me, and I am grieved because of what my sin cost Him." This sorrow produces change — real, lasting repentance that turns the life in a new direction.

Worldly sorrow is grief over getting caught or experiencing consequences. It says, "I feel bad because of what this is costing me." This

sorrow produces no real change — only temporary remorse that fades until the next temptation arrives.

The Trap of Cheap Grace.

Many believers have been taught that grace means sin does not matter. They have heard messages that focus entirely on God's love and mercy without addressing His holiness and His command to walk in righteousness. This creates a dangerous mindset where a person sins freely, asks for forgiveness casually, and returns to the same behavior without conviction.

Paul addressed this directly:

""What shall we say then? Shall we continue in sin that grace may abound? Certainly not! How shall we who died to sin live any longer in it?""

— **Romans 6:1–2 (NKJV)**

Grace is not permission to sin. Grace is the power of God that enables you to stop sinning. It forgives the past and empowers the future. A person who uses grace as a license to continue in sin has misunderstood the Gospel entirely.

""For the grace of God that brings salvation has appeared to all men, teaching us that, denying ungodliness and worldly lusts, we should live soberly, righteously, and godly in the present age.""

— **Titus 2:11–12 (NKJV)**

Grace teaches. It teaches you to deny ungodliness and worldly lusts. It teaches you to live soberly, righteously, and in a godly manner. If your understanding of grace does not include these teachings, it is incomplete.

The Fear That Forgiveness Has Limits.

Some believers are trapped not by presumption but by despair. They believe they have sinned too many times or too severely for God to forgive them again. The enemy uses this fear to keep them running from God instead of toward Him.

But the Word is clear:

""Let us therefore come boldly to the throne of grace, that we may obtain mercy and find grace to help in time of need.""

— Hebrews 4:16 (NKJV)

The throne of grace does not have limited hours. It does not close after a certain number of offenses. It remains open for every believer who comes in sincere repentance. Come boldly — not arrogantly, but confidently — because the access was purchased by the blood of Jesus.

Instruction in the Word

The story of the woman caught in adultery in John chapter 8 is one of the most important passages for understanding how Jesus responds to sin. Religious leaders dragged her before Jesus, demanding that He condemn her according to the Law. She was guilty — there was no question about that.

And Jesus said:

""He who is without sin among you, let him throw a stone at her first.""

— John 8:7 (NKJV)

One by one, her accusers left. And Jesus — the only Person in that moment with the right to condemn her — said:

""Neither do I condemn you; go and sin no more.""

— John 8:11 (NKJV)

Two things are present here that must be held together: mercy and holiness. "Neither do I condemn you" — that is mercy. "Go and sin no more" — that is holiness. Jesus did not condemn her, but He also did not tell her to continue living the same way. He forgave the past and commanded a different future.

This is the balance every forgiven believer must embrace: you are forgiven, yes. The blood of Jesus covers your sin, yes. But you are now called to walk differently. Forgiveness is not a return to the same life — it

is a launching pad into a new one.

The Way of Righteousness

What does life after forgiveness look like? Paul answers:

""Likewise you also, reckon yourselves to be dead indeed to sin, but alive to God in Christ Jesus our Lord. Therefore do not let sin reign in your mortal body, that you should obey it in its lusts.""

— **Romans 6:11–12 (NKJV)**

You are dead to sin. That does not mean sin will never tempt you. It means sin no longer has the right to rule you. You have been transferred from the kingdom of darkness to the kingdom of light. You have new citizenship, new authority, and new power — the power of the Holy Spirit living inside you.

Practicing righteousness after forgiveness involves:

1. Renewing the mind. Replace the thought patterns that led to sin with the truth of God's Word. What you meditate on determines what you act on. Fill your mind with Scripture, with worship, with truth — and the lies that led you into sin will lose their power.

2. Building accountability. Bring your struggle into the light. Confess to a mature, trustworthy believer. Sin thrives in secrecy. When you invite someone into your journey, you gain prayer, support, and honest correction when you need it.

3. Removing access to temptation. If the environment, the relationship, the device, or the habit creates a pathway to sin, remove it. Jesus said, "If your right hand causes you to sin, cut it off" (Matthew 5:30). He was speaking in strong language to make a point: remove whatever gives the enemy a foothold in your life.

4. Building a consistent prayer life. Prayer keeps you connected to God's strength. When you pray daily, your spirit stays sensitive to conviction, your heart remains soft, and your willpower is reinforced by

divine power.

5. Walking in the Spirit daily. The Spirit of God produces in you love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness, and self-control (Galatians 5:22–23). These are not produced by effort alone — they are the fruit of staying connected to the Holy Spirit through prayer, worship, and obedience.

""Therefore, if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation; old things have passed away; behold, all things have become new.""

— 2 Corinthians 5:17 (NKJV)

You are a new creation. The old has passed. This is not just a theological statement — it is a declaration of identity. You are not defined by what you did. You are defined by what Christ has done in you. Walk in that newness.

Practical Steps to Walk Forward

1. Confess your sin specifically to God. Do not use vague language. Name what you did. Acknowledge it fully before Him.

2. Repent — not just with words, but with direction. Repentance means a change of mind and direction. Turn away from the sin. Make practical changes that demonstrate your turning.

3. Receive God's forgiveness by faith. Once you have confessed and repented, believe that He has forgiven you. Do not keep punishing yourself for what God has already pardoned.

4. Make restitution where possible. If your sin has harmed someone, take steps to make it right — apologize, repay, restore trust. This is part of genuine repentance.

5. Build hedges against future falls. Identify what led to the sin and put boundaries in place. Change your environment, your habits, your schedule, or your associations if necessary.

6. Return to daily fellowship with God. Do not allow guilt to keep you from prayer. Go back to your quiet time. Open the Word again. Worship again. God receives the repentant sinner with open arms.

7. Seek counsel if the pattern is deep. If the sin is a pattern you cannot break alone, seek a Christian counselor, pastor, or deliverance minister. Some strongholds require targeted spiritual intervention.

Healing Prayer

A Prayer of Repentance and Forgiveness

Father God, I come before You in the name of Jesus Christ. I have sinned against You and against Your holiness. I do not make excuses. I do not minimize. I own what I have done, and I am grieved — not just because of the consequences, but because I have offended You, my Father who loves me. Lord, I repent. I turn from this sin completely. I ask You to forgive me by the blood of Jesus Christ. Wash me. Cleanse me. Create in me a clean heart and renew a right spirit within me (Psalm 51:10). I receive Your mercy today. And I commit, by the power of Your Spirit, to walk in newness of life. I will not return to this bondage. Strengthen me, Lord. In Jesus' name, amen.

A Deliverance Prayer

In the name of Jesus Christ, I break every spiritual chain connected to this sin. I renounce every demonic agreement I have made through my disobedience. I cancel every assignment of the enemy that was given access through my sin. I plead the blood of Jesus over my mind, my body, and my spirit. I command every unclean spirit that entered through this sin to leave me now, in Jesus' name. I close every door I opened and I seal it with the blood of the Lamb. I am forgiven. I am cleansed. I am delivered. No weapon formed against me shall prosper. Amen.

A Prayer for Strength to Walk Differently

Holy Spirit, I cannot do this in my own strength. I have tried before and failed. But Your Word says I can do all things through Christ who strengthens me (Philippians 4:13). I lean on that promise today. Give me the power to resist temptation. Give me the wisdom to build hedges. Give me the discipline to maintain my prayer life and stay in Your Word. Produce Your fruit in my life — love, joy, peace, patience, self-control. I yield to Your leading. Walk with me daily so I do not fall again. In Jesus' name, amen.

Prophetic Declarations

"I am forgiven by the blood of Jesus Christ."

"I will not return to the bondage that Christ delivered me from."

"Grace does not give me permission to sin. Grace empowers me to live holy."

"I am a new creation. The old has passed. All things are new."

"I reckon myself dead to sin and alive to God in Christ Jesus."

"Sin will not reign in my body. I serve God, not my flesh."

"God is faithful and just to forgive me. I receive His cleansing now."

"I will walk in the light as He is in the light."

"My past does not define me. Christ's finished work defines me."

"I choose righteousness, holiness, and obedience from this day forward."

Reflection Questions

Reflect on These Questions

1. What sin are you carrying guilt over? Have you confessed it fully to God — without excuses or minimizing?

2. Is your sorrow godly sorrow (grief over offending God) or worldly sorrow (grief over consequences)? Be honest.

3. Have you been using God's grace as a reason to continue in sin? What does true repentance look like for you?

4. What practical changes do you need to make to prevent yourself from falling into the same sin again?

5. Is there someone you have harmed through your sin? What steps of restitution can you take?

6. Have you returned to daily prayer, Scripture, and fellowship with God since your fall? If not, what is stopping you?

7. Do you believe God has forgiven you? If not, what lie are you believing that contradicts 1 John 1:9?

Child of God, you sinned. But you are not defined by your sin — you are defined by the blood that covers it. Repent. Receive. Rise. And walk forward in the righteousness that Christ has made available to you. He will not abandon the repentant heart. Come home.

A CLOSING PRAYER

Father God, in the mighty name of Jesus Christ, I bring before You this reader who has sinned and carries the weight of guilt. Lord, You see their heart. You know whether their repentance is sincere. And I pray that it is — that they are not simply sorry for the consequences, but grieved that they have offended Your holiness.

For the one who truly repents, I declare Your Word over them: "If we confess our sins, He is faithful and just to forgive us our sins and to cleanse us from all unrighteousness." Cleanse them now, Lord. Remove the stain. Lift the guilt. Restore the fellowship.

And strengthen them to walk differently from this day forward. Let Your grace not only forgive the past but empower a righteous future. In Jesus' name, amen.

AN INVITATION TO CHRIST

If you have never received Jesus Christ as your Lord and Savior, or if sin has pulled you so far from God that you feel you need to start completely over, pray this prayer with sincerity: "Lord Jesus, I am a sinner. I have broken Your laws and grieved Your heart. But I believe You died on the cross for my sins and rose again. I repent — I turn away from my old life and I turn to You. Forgive me. Cleanse me. Make me new. I receive You as my Lord and Savior. Fill me with Your Holy Spirit and give me the power to live a life that honors You. I will not go back. I am Yours. In Jesus' name, amen."

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HEALING FOR THE HOMES SERIES

GOD, I SINNED. WILL YOU FORGIVE ME?

Have you fallen into sin and now wonder if God can still receive you? This Healing for the Homes booklet speaks to the heart burdened by guilt and regret. Through scripture, repentance, mercy, and prayer, Joshua Matthews shows that forgiveness is still available through Jesus Christ, and that the Father is ready to restore all who return to Him.

His mercy is still reaching for you.



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